Spot a phishing message

Cyber safety · Level 1 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Name five warning signs of a scam message.
- Sort printed messages into “scam” and “safe” and point to the warning sign.
- Explain how to check a message another way, such as asking a trusted adult.

Stop, check, report

- Spot a warning sign
- Stop: don’t tap or reply
- Check another way
- Report it, then delete it

Scam or safe?: Scam sort

1. Warm-up (5 min): Tell the gate story: a stranger says, “The head teacher sent me for the exam papers.” Ask pupils what they would do.
2. Teach (8 min): Explain phishing: a message that pretends to be someone you trust.
3. Scam sort (14 min): Groups get eight message cards.
4. Share (7 min): Each group reads one scam card aloud and says what they would do: stop, tell a trusted adult, check another way, then report and delete.
5. Wrap-up (6 min): Exit ticket: each pupil writes one warning sign and one safe action.

Write eight short messages on cards, four scams and four safe. Scams: a prize, an urgent fee, a request for a code, a link from an unknown number. Safe: a timetable, a sports reminder, a library notice, a parents’ meeting. Make one set per group.

Let’s discuss

1. Would you hand over the exam papers?
2. How could you check whether the story is true?
3. Which warning sign do you see?

Exit ticket

- One warning sign + what I would do if I saw it.